

Device	Main Function	Typical Ports/Connections	Example in a Home Network
Switch	Connects multiple wired devices within the same Local Area Network (LAN) and forwards data based on MAC addresses.	5, 8, 16, or 24+ Ethernet (RJ-45) ports.	Connecting a desktop PC, smart TV, printer, and gaming console to the home network.
Router	Connects the home network to the Internet and routes data between different networks. Often provides DHCP, NAT, and basic firewall features.	1 WAN port + 4 or more LAN Ethernet (RJ-45) ports; may also include Wi-Fi antennas.	Connecting your home devices to your Internet Service Provider (ISP).
Hub	Connects multiple wired devices but broadcasts incoming data to all ports (does not filter traffic).	Typically 4, 8, or 16 Ethernet (RJ-45) ports.	Rarely used today; mostly found in older networks or for demonstrations.
Firewall	Monitors and filters incoming and outgoing network traffic based on security rules to protect the network.	Usually 2 or more Ethernet (RJ-45) ports (WAN and LAN); software firewalls may have no physical ports.	Blocking unauthorized Internet access while allowing safe traffic.
Access Point (AP)	Provides wireless (Wi-Fi) access to the wired network, allowing devices to connect wirelessly.	1 Ethernet (RJ-45) port for uplink; Wi-Fi radios (2.4 GHz/5 GHz/6 GHz).	Extending Wi-Fi coverage to another floor or room in the house.